⌧ WA 09-Telecom Administrator — NEC Study & Reference Guide

> A curated resource hub for Washington State **09-Telecommunications Administrator** candidates studying the National Electrical Code (NFPA 70), paired with Anki flashcard tools for retention.
> *Last updated: April 2026 · Exam references: WA L&I 09-Telecommunications Administrator, NEC 2020, RCW 19.28, WAC 296-46B*

⌧ WA 09-Telecom Administrator Exam Blueprint

This is an **open-book exam** administered by PSI. You must pass **each section separately** with **70% or greater**.

Exam Structure

Section	Time Allowed	Questions	Passing Score
NEC & Theory	2 hours	30 questions	≥70%
WA Codes (RCW & WAC)	1 hour	17 questions	≥70%
Total	3 hours	47 questions	Both sections ≥70%

NEC & Theory Section — Question Distribution

The question counts below are **approximate** per the official L&I bulletin. Knowledge areas listed without a question count are still in scope but are weighted lightly or combined with adjacent articles.

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NEC & Theory — 30 Questions Total
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Article(s)                                  Questions
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NEC 90        Introduction                      2  ██
NEC 100-110   General Requirements               3  ███
NEC 200-225,
  280-285     Wiring & Protection               —  (in scope, low weight)
NEC 230       Services                          —  (in scope, low weight)
NEC 240       Overcurrent Protection            —  (in scope, low weight)
NEC 250       Grounding & Bonding               3  ███
NEC 300-398   Wiring Methods                    3  ███
NEC 400-427,
  455-480     Electrical Equipment              —  (in scope, low weight)
NEC 430-450   Motors, HVAC, Generators & Transformers  —  (in scope, low weight)
NEC 490       Equipment > 600 V                 —  (in scope, low weight)
NEC 500-516   Hazardous Locations               1  ▉
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NEC 517-590   Special Occupancies                      —  (in scope, low weight)
NEC 600-695   Special Equipment                       —  (in scope, low weight)
NEC 700-702   Emergency & Standby Systems              —  (in scope, low weight)
NEC 705-780   Special Conditions                      4  ▓▓▓▓
NEC 800-830   Communication Systems ◀ CORE FOCUS        8  ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓
General Trade Knowledge & Theory                      6  ▓▓▓▓▓▓
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WA Laws & Rules (RCW & WAC)                          17  ▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓▓
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TOTAL                                                47
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⚠ Priority Callouts

> **NEC 800-830 (Communication Systems) carries the most NEC points — 8 of 30 questions.** This is the domain-specific core of the exam. Prioritize Articles 800, 805, 810, 820, and 830 above all other NEC sections.

> **WA Laws & Rules (RCW & WAC) is worth more than any single NEC section — 17 of 47 total questions.** Study RCW 19.28 and WAC 296-46B thoroughly alongside the NEC.

Study Priority Order

Priority	Section	Questions	Why
⊠ Critical	NEC 800-830 Communications Systems	8	Domain-specific core
⊠ Critical	WA Laws & Rules (RCW & WAC)	17	Largest single section
⊠ High	General Trade Knowledge & Theory	6	Broad, requires breadth
⊠ High	NEC 705-780 Special Conditions	4	Often overlooked
⊠ Medium	NEC 90, 100-110, 250, 300-398	2-3 each	Foundational code
⬇ Low	All remaining articles	~0-1 each	In scope; low weight

⊠ NEC / NFPA 70 — Official & Free Access

Free Official Access to NFPA 70

- ⊠ NFPA Free Access Portal — Official NFPA 70 standard development page
- ⊠ NFPA 70 Online (2023 Edition — Preview Mode) — Free online read access (requires free NFPA account for full access)
- ⊠ NFPA Free Codes & Standards List — All NFPA documents available at no cost
- ⊠ NFPA Sign-In / Account Portal — Login to access full code text

Free PDFs & Downloads

- NFPA 70 2023 PDF (accindia.org mirror) — Full 2023 NEC PDF
- NEC 2017 Handbook PDF (edufire.ir) — NEC Handbook with commentary
- Lori's Web — NFPA 70 PDF Archive — Older edition reference

Chapter 8 — Communications Systems (Telco Core)

Chapter 8 of NEC is the primary chapter for telecommunications administrators. It operates independently from Chapters 1–7 except where explicitly referenced. It accounts for **8 of 30 NEC questions** on the WA 09 exam — more than any other single article group.

Article 800 — General Requirements for Communications Systems

Article 800 covers general requirements common across all Chapter 8 articles, including grounding, bonding, listing requirements, and installation of communications cables (twisted-pair, coaxial, fiber). **High-priority for the exam.**

- Nassau National Cable — Article 800 Explained — Plain-language breakdown of Article 800 (free)
- EC&M — Article 800: Communications Circuits — Code basics overview
- EC&M — Article 800 Grounding Rules — Grounding and bonding focus
- Mike Holt — Article 800 PDF (free) — Study PDF sample from Mike Holt
- Mike Holt — Free Communications Systems PDF (Articles 800, 805, 810, 820) — Free 2020 NEC-based PDF download
- MyNFPA70.com — Chapter 8 Overview — Chapter 8 article index

Article 805 — Communications Circuits

Article 805 covers wiring methods, cable types, and installation requirements for communications circuits (voice, data, low-voltage signaling) from the service point to terminal equipment.

- MyNFPA70.com — Chapter 8 (Articles Index) — Includes Article 805 navigation
- Mike Holt — Free Communications PDF (includes 805) — Covers 800/805/810/820 in one guide
- ElectricalLicenseRenewal.com — Article 800/805 Content — CE course-style breakdown

Article 810 — Antenna Systems

Article 810 covers antenna systems for radio and television reception, including grounding of masts, lead-in conductors, and satellite dishes.

- Mike Holt — Free Communications PDF (includes 810)

- MyNFPA70.com — Chapter 8 Articles Index

Article 820 — Community Antenna TV / Radio Distribution (CATV/Coax)

Article 820 covers coaxial cable systems used for distributing high-frequency signals — cable TV, CATV, CCTV, and broadband over coax.

- Scribd — NEC Articles 800, 810, 820 PDF — Free read access
- Syston Cable — Communications Cables NEC Ratings PDF — Cable ratings and Article 820 reference
- Mike Holt — Free Communications PDF (includes 820)

Article 830 — Network-Powered Broadband Communications

Article 830 covers network-powered broadband systems (e.g., fiber + power combined delivery systems from utility to premises).

- MyNFPA70.com — Chapter 8 Articles Index
- NFPA 70 Online (2023) — Free preview; full access with free account

Article 840 — Premises-Powered Broadband Communications

Article 840 covers optical fiber-based broadband systems where power is supplied from the customer premises (e.g., ONT installations for fiber internet — directly relevant to FTTH/FTTx telecom work).

- MyNFPA70.com — Chapter 8 Articles Index
- NFPA 70 Online (2023)

Related Standards & Codes for Telecom Admins

BICSI & Structured Cabling Standards

- BICSI Official Site — Industry body for telecom infrastructure; free resources for members, some public
- BICSI Codes, Standards & Regulations Reference (Scribd) — Free read
- ANSI/NECA/BICSI 568 Reference (via Mike Holt Article 800 PDF) — Referenced directly in NEC Article 800 for cabling installation
- Fresno State Telecom Infrastructure Design Standards PDF — Real-world institutional standards doc (free)

Additional Free Study References

- Studylib — NFPA 70 NEC 2023 — Searchable online NEC 2023
- EC&M Code Basics Library — Free NEC article explanations by EC&M magazine
- ElectricalLicenseRenewal.com — NEC Content Library — Free NEC article summaries in CE format
- NFPA — Understanding NFPA 70 Overview — Official NFPA intro guide

Practice Questions & Tests

> **ℹ Note on scope:** The free practice resources below cover the **full NEC** (all chapters and articles). The WA 09-Telecom Administrator exam draws from a specific subset of NEC articles — use the blueprint above to prioritize your study time. Focus the most practice on:
>
> - **NEC 800-830** (8 Qs) — Communication Systems
> - **General Trade Knowledge & Theory** (6 Qs)
> - **NEC 705-780** (4 Qs) — Special Conditions
> - **NEC 250** (3 Qs) — Grounding & Bonding
> - **NEC 300-398** (3 Qs) — Wiring Methods
> - **NEC 100-110** (3 Qs) — General Requirements
> - **WA RCW & WAC** (17 Qs) — Washington State Laws & Rules *(separate resource needed)*

⭑ WA 09-Telecom Specific Practice Tests

Purpose-built for the Washington State 09-Telecommunications Administrator exam using NEC 2020, RCW 19.28, and WAC 296-46B:

- ContractorTests.com — WA 09 Telecommunications Administrator Practice Test — 2,400+ questions with answer keys and code references (paid)
- DakotaPrep — WA Electrical Administrator Exam Prep — Includes 09-Telecom topic breakdown
- PSI Candidate Information Bulletin (PDF) — Official exam instructions from the testing provider
- L&I — Telecommunications Administrator Exam Page — Official Washington L&I page

Free General NEC Practice Questions

These cover broad NEC content. Filter your study toward the telco admin blueprint sections listed above:

- ElectricianExamPracticeTests.com — Ohm's Law Test Questions — Electrical theory fundamentals

- ThompsonLearningCo.com — Free Electrician Exam Practice Test (2020 NEC) — General NEC 2020 questions
- EC&M Code Basics Library — Free NEC article explanations
- ElectricalLicenseRenewal.com — NEC Content Library — CE-format article summaries
- NFPA — Understanding NFPA 70 Overview — Official NFPA intro

Video Study — WA Telecom Exam

- YouTube — Washington State 09-Telecommunications Exam — Exam-focused video walkthrough
- YouTube — Mastering the WA State Electrical Administrator's Exam — Covers NEC, WA codes, and test strategy

Anki — Flashcard Study Tools

Use Anki (Desktop & Web)

- AnkiWeb — Use Online (No Download) — Study in browser, sync across devices
- Download Anki Desktop — Windows, Mac, Linux

AnkiDroid (Android)

- AnkiDroid — Google Play Store

Anki Tutorial

- Anki Tutorial Video (YouTube)

⚙ Recommended Anki Settings for NEC Study

Optimized Settings (FSRS + V3 Scheduler)

Setting	Recommended Value	Notes
Scheduler	V3 (auto in modern Anki)	Required for FSRS
FSRS	Enabled	Best retention algorithm
Desired Retention	90–95%	95% = 2x workload; 90% is a solid balance
Learning Steps	`25m`	Single intraday step; FSRS-compatible
Relearning Steps	`10m`	For lapsed/forgotten cards
Graduating Interval	3d	First review interval after graduating
Easy Interval	`4d`	Skip-ahead interval for instant recalls

Setting	Recommended Value	Notes
New Cards/Day	9999 (or your pace)	Don't let Anki cap your flow
Maximum Reviews/Day	9999	Let FSRS manage the queue

Button Guide: Press **Again** only when wrong. Press **Good** as your default correct answer. Use **Hard** sparingly for correct-but-difficult. Use **Easy** only when the card was instant and effortless.

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